Worksheet & Answer Key

Inherited traits are characteristics that an organism receives from its parents through genetic information. These traits can be physical, such as eye color or height, or they can be behavioral, like intelligence or personality. The _____ of these traits is determined by the combination of genes an individual inherits from their parents. Some inherited traits may not be expressed until later in life, while others are apparent at birth.

Word Bank:

inherited, physical, genetic, combination, expressed, apparent, organisms, parents

Fill in the blanks:

1. An organism receives characteristics from its _____ through genetic information.

2. These traits can be _____, such as eye color or height, or they can be behavioral.

3. The _____ of these traits is determined by the combination of genes an individual inherits from their parents.

4. Some inherited traits may not be _____ until later in life, while others are apparent at birth.

5. Traits that an organism receives through genetic information are called _____ traits.

6. These traits can be _____, such as eye color or height, or they can be behavioral like intelligence or personality.

7. The _____ of genes an individual inherits from their parents determines the inherited traits.

8. Inherited traits can be _____ or behavioral.

9. Inherited traits are characteristics that an organism receives from its _____ through genetic information.

■ Answer Key (for teachers only):

1. parents
2. physical
3. genetic
4. combination
5. expressed
6. apparent
7. organisms
8. parents